SOP-GOV-001 · Who reads the reading room: two owners, one readers team

SOP GOV-001 | Status draft | Changed 2026-11-01 | For Owners and the lab

Department: GOV · **ID:** 001 · **Status:** draft (approved when tagged) · **Owner:** the organisation's owners; the lab executes · **Last changed:** 2026-11-01

Purpose

How a person is given **Read** on the shop's private reading room, how they accept, and how the lab checks it from their side. In the fleet's larger organisations this procedure is about a board of directors and its committees; a shop has neither, so here it is about the two owners and the people the shop chooses to let read.

Scope

`taylordwraps/reading-room`, through the closed team `readers`. **GitHub membership is not a role in the shop:** the shop decides who reads; this procedure only opens the door for the people it names. Write access, the shop's own store and anything with money in it are out of scope.

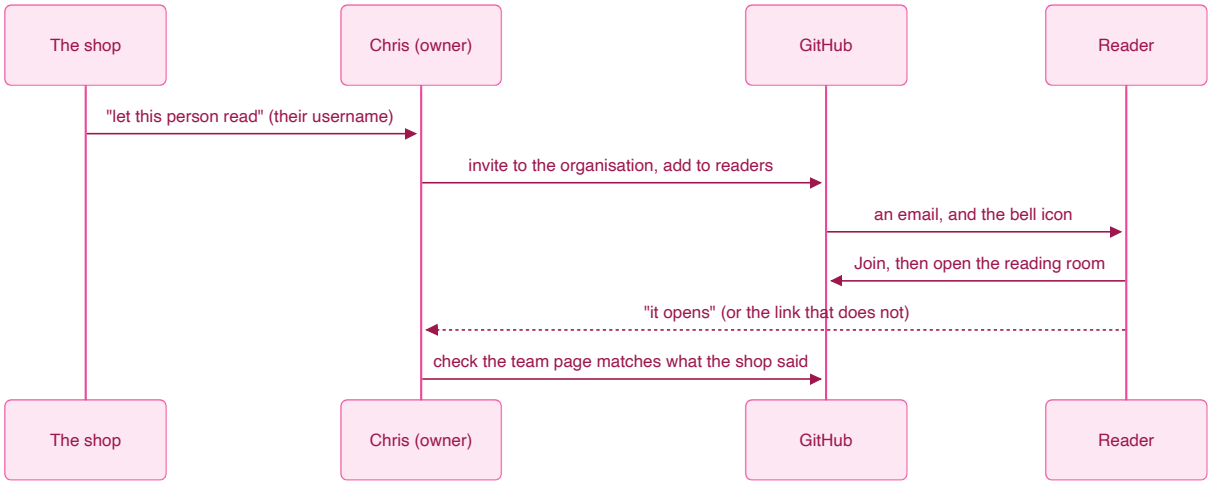
Roles

Role	Does
The shop (an owner's seat)	names who may read, by their GitHub username; can add or remove anyone itself
Chris W (an owner, the lab's steward)	creates the team once, adds the people the shop names, checks
Reader	accepts, reads, says when a link does not open
Helper	prepares the commands for an owner; never adds a person on its own

Prerequisites

The reading room exists under `taylordwraps` (an organisation, not a personal account: a personal private repository cannot give anyone read-only access, SOP-IT-002). The person has their own account with two-factor sign-in (SOP-COM-001).

Who does what, in order



Steps: the lab, once

1. Create the team, closed, and give it Read on the room only:

```
gh api -X POST orgs/taylordwraps/teams -f name=readers -f privacy=closed
gh api -X PUT orgs/taylordwraps/teams/readers/repos/taylordwraps/reading-room -f
permission=pull
```

You should see: `readers` on the organisation's Teams page, with one repository.

Steps: each new reader

1. The shop names the person and their username, wherever it already talks to the lab. *You should see:* the username written down in the lab's notes, with the date and who asked.
2. Add them (an owner's action):

```
gh api -X PUT orgs/taylordwraps/teams/readers/memberships/<login> -f role=member
```

You should see: `"state": "pending"` until they accept, then `"active"`.
3. The reader accepts (SOP-COM-001, step 3) and opens `https://github.com/taylordwraps/reading-room`. *You should see:* the room's index.
4. **The shop's own seat** is an owner's, not a reader's: `gh api -X PUT orgs/taylordwraps/memberships/<login> -f role=admin`. Owners read everything and need no team.

Steps: a reader leaves

1. The shop says so (or the person asks). 2. `gh api -X DELETE orgs/taylordwraps/teams/readers/memberships/<login>`.
2. If they hold nothing else, remove them from the organisation on its **People** page. *You should see:* a 404 for them on the room's link.

Verification

`gh api orgs/taylordwraps/teams/readers/members --jq '.[].login'` lists exactly the people the shop named; `gh api orgs/taylordwraps --jq .default_repository_permission` prints `none`, so nobody reads the room except owners and the team.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	What to do
The reader sees a 404	invitation not accepted, signed in as another account, or two-factor sign-in not on	SOP-COM-001 steps 2 and 3; check the username
A member reads the room without being in `readers`	they are an owner, or the base permission was changed back to Read	read the base permission; never switch it back to fix one person
The invitation never arrives	sent to a username with a typo	delete the pending invitation on the People page, send again

Related

- SOP-COM-001 *New to GitHub: your first hour* · SOP-GOV-002 *GitHub collaboration* (owners, teams, base permission none) · SOP-IT-002 *Reading room and helper access*
- The universal SOP-GOV-001 in `my-template/sop-template` (the same shape, for a board and its committees)

Change log

Date	Change	By
2026-11-01	Drafted for the shop from the universal SOP-GOV-001: two owners and one readers team instead of a board and committees; the order of who does what in Mermaid	Alfred